

saving, investment and taxation can help India reach the true Hindu growth rate of 7%. The literature, they note, prescribe the Hindu saving rate of 33.3%, which can be accompanied by a real investment rate of 35%.

If the 7% growth rate is maintained on a trend basis, India will emerge as the second-largest economy in terms of market exchange rate as well as purchasing power parity.

As India looks to become the fourth-largest and possibly the third-largest economy over the next few years, the arguments put forth in the book certainly merit serious consideration. There is also no doubt that both investments and savings, faltering in recent years, need to be bolstered for sustained economic growth.

But going beyond these numbers, Srivastava and his co-authors also point out that

India needs several policy reforms to shore up its long-term growth story. They also highlight the challenges that policymakers will have to address to sustain 7% growth over the long term that is required to make India a developed economy.

The authors call for a considerable reallocation of resources, especially from the government,

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favouring education, training and skill building. This will help India reap the demographic dividend, they note. It will also be needed for the country's growing adoption of digitalisation and modern technologies related to artificial intelligence and Generative AI.

The authors have also highlighted the challenges of deglobalisation and frequent supply chain disruptions, along with climate change, which will slow growth in India and the world. Ageing populations in advanced economies and rise in the working age population of sub-Saharan Africa and how India develops a strategy to interact with them have also been flagged.

Whether you are a student of economics, economy watcher or just curious about economic history, this book gives a succinct yet comprehensive account of the Indian economy since Independence, the policies implemented, and what needs to be done.

Equally importantly, it's easy to read even for a layperson, with well researched data that helps readers get genuine facts whether or not they agree with the arguments. The chapters are interspersed with data tables and charts to elaborate on several issues put forth by the authors.

In fact, the authors also "acknowledge the contribution of a common man's understanding of various social and economic issues in the evolution of India's growth through a number of illustrations" that they compiled from various online and media sources, including newspapers.

This is a book that is in sync with the modern economy and the needs of today's readers. **BT**

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AVERAGE ACTUAL AND TREND REAL GDP GROWTH RATES (%)			
Growth Phase	Years Covered	Actual Growth	Trend Growth
► Colonial legacy phase	1951-52 to 1962-63	3.9	4
► Socialist pattern phase	1963-64 to 1972-73	3.5	3.6
► Mixed economy phase	1973-74 to 1983-84	4.2	4
► First reform phase	1984-85 to 1997-98	5.4	5.5
► Accelerating growth phase	1998-99 to 2011-12	6.5	6.5
► Global crises phase	2012-13 to 2024-25	6	6.1
► Hindu growth phase (Potential future growth)	2025-26 to 2050-51	7	7